

HEADLINE JUDGMENT

Note: 30 Jul figures are intraday prints. A data flag first: the extract's 29 Jul row did not refresh — every field is identical to my 29 Jul AM snapshot to four decimal places and MOVE, VIX and SOFR are blank, so 29 Jul is a stale snapshot, not a close. The last fully confirmed close is 28 Jul, and all trigger tests below run off it. **Score HOLDS at 25/30 — all six channels unchanged, a twelfth session at 25 — and this is the sharpest demonstration of the scale cap the monitor has produced.** In twenty-four hours the war's de-escalation track was dismantled and the score did not move. The strike pause is over: after an IRGC ballistic-missile salvo at Muwaffaq Salti Air Base at Azraq in Jordan and a CENTCOM facility — five missiles, all intercepted, no casualties — the US and Saudi Arabia struck Iran-backed militias across eastern Iraq, Riyadh's first offensive combat action of the war, and CENTCOM then resumed strikes on Iranian territory on the night of 29–30 Jul, calling them 'a powerful response to yesterday's attempted Iranian attacks on US forces based in the Middle East.' Trump: 'They're going to get a beating.' The quiet-night count is back to zero after four. Diplomacy went backwards in the same window: Deputy FM Gharibabadi rejected Oman's 50-50 joint-management plan outright on 29 Jul, disavowed the internationally established Traffic Separation Scheme, demanded the entire inbound lane under Iranian control and said the strait 'will remain closed, and we are prepared for a restart of war.' Neither event can raise the score, because maritime and escalation have both been pinned at 5/5 since 10 and 9 Jul. **The hold is an artifact of the scale, not a judgment that anything is stable.** What the four market channels did is the substantive story, and it is a rates story. The FOMC held at 3.50–3.75% on a 9–3 vote — Hammack, Kashkari and Logan all dissenting for a 25 bp hike — and Chair Warsh, who has removed forward guidance from the statement, insisted 'There is only a target, and it is 2 percent.' The long end did not believe him. The 30Y prints 5.2060%, **the first reading above 5.20% in the entire series**, up 10.91 bp; the 10Y is 4.6794%, 2.94 bp back above its own 4.65% line; 2s10s has steepened 8.97 bp to +40.67 bp, the largest one-day steepening of the war; the 10Y breakeven is back above its pre-war anchor after three sessions below; and 5Y5Y forward inflation prints 2.3311% — a war high, 3.11 bp **through** the 2.30% upgrade trigger and only the second reading above 2.30% on record. A hold against three hike dissents, met by a bear steepener with breakevens up and the dollar down 0.51 to 100.87 on a night the US resumed bombing Iran, is the market marking down the Fed's inflation credibility rather than seeking a haven. Two lines that were disarmed yesterday are armed this morning: **Stage-4 Threshold B now satisfies both legs simultaneously for the first time in the war**, and US-inflation is through its trigger. Neither has a confirmed close behind it, and the two-close rule is the only thing holding the score at 25 — while yesterday's most probable next move, a Treasury 5→4 downgrade, is dead, its cushion above the 5.00% line blown out from 8.86 bp to 20.60 bp. Crude followed the news up but not far: Brent \$87.72, +\$2.68, still \$7.28 below the \$95 trigger, active COA \$89.96. September hike odds have jumped to roughly 56% from 32–38%. Sequencing 25 → 25 → 25.

1 · Live tape

Oil and natural gas — Bloomberg front-month / active

30 Jul 2026 readings are intraday prints. The extract's 29 Jul row did not refresh and is a stale AM snapshot, not a close (MOVE / VIX / SOFR blank, every other field identical to my 29 Jul quote); the last confirmed close is 28 Jul. d/d deltas are 30 Jul intraday vs that unrefreshed 29 Jul row and are therefore indicative; w/w deltas are vs the 23 Jul close. Restated continuation series (front-month CO2/CL2) in force.

Benchmark	Intraday 30 Jul	Δ d/d	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent front-month	\$87.72 /bbl (H 88.18 / L 86.70)	+\$2.68 (–\$6.54 w/w)	from \$72.48 (+21.0%) — a \$15.24/bbl premium; second consecutive gain on the strike resumption and Iran's rejection of the Omani plan; active COA prints \$89.96	CO2 Comdty (Close)
Brent · 28 Jul close (last confirmed)	\$82.08 /bbl	–\$3.79 on the day	\$12.92 below the \$95 trigger on a close basis; \$9.60 above the \$72.48 anchor. This remains the reference close because 29 Jul never printed one.	CO2 Comdty (Close)
WTI front-month	\$81.67 /bbl (H 82.09 / L 80.80)	+\$1.70 (–\$5.34 w/w)	from \$67.02 (+21.9%) — the CL2 artifact persists: active CLA prints \$84.10 against CL2's \$81.67	CL2 Comdty (Close)
Brent–WTI spread	\$6.05 /bbl	+\$0.98	–\$5.9 on the active contracts (COA \$89.96 / CLA \$84.10)	derived
Henry Hub natural gas	\$2.728 /MMBtu	+\$0.077 (–\$0.188 w/w)	from \$3.06 (–10.9%) — US gas still BELOW pre-war; not Hormuz-exposed	NGA Comdty (Close)
TTF Dutch gas (active)	€60.630 /MWh	+€1.525 (–€1.268 w/w)	from €31.23 (+94.2%) — second consecutive gain, back within €2.95 of the 24 Jul war record €63.58	TZTA Comdty (Close)
Japan/Asia LNG (28 Jul close — no 29 or 30 Jul print)	¥3,418	–¥74 vs the 27 Jul ¥3,492	from ¥1,669 (+104.8%) — two sessions now with no print; flagged, NOT carried forward	JGLA Comdty (Close)

US Treasuries and inflation expectations — Bloomberg

30 Jul 2026 yields are intraday and are the first look at the post-FOMC repricing (the decision landed at 2pm ET on 29 Jul, 02:00 Singapore on 30 Jul). d/d is vs the unrefreshed 29 Jul row; w/w vs 23 Jul. Third-party reporting puts the true 29 Jul close at 2Y 4.33% and 10Y 4.647%, above the extract's stale row, so the moves below understate the front end and are directionally conservative at the long end. See section 2.1.

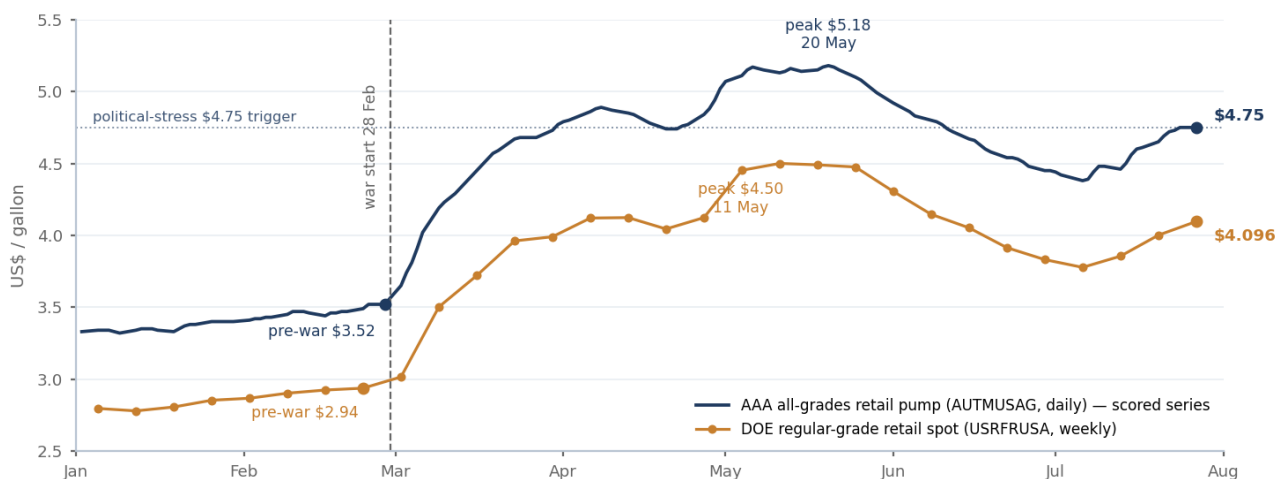
Tenor	Yield (%) — intraday 30 Jul	Δ d/d (bp)	Δ w/w (bp)	Δ vs pre-war (bp)	BBG ticker
2-year UST	4.27	–2.5	–7.6	+89.6 (from 3.37%) — the only tenor lower on the day	USGG2YR Index
5-year UST	4.41	+2.8	–4.6	+90.5 (from 3.50%)	USGG5YR Index
10-year UST	4.68	+6.5	–1.4	+74.2 (from 3.94%) — 2.94 bp back ABOVE the 4.65% Stage-4 leg, which had reset on two sub-line closes	USGG10YR Index
30-year UST	5.21	+10.9	+4.7	+59.5 (from 4.61%) — 5.2060%, the first print above 5.20% in the series : 0.60 bp through the Stage-4 leg, 20.60 bp above the 5.00% downgrade line vs 8.86 bp on Tuesday	USGG30YR Index
2s10s spread	+40.7 bp	+9.0	+6.3	–15.0 (flatter than pre-war), but the largest one-day steepening of the war	USYC2Y10 Index

Tenor	Yield (%) — intraday 30 Jul	Δ d/d (bp)	Δ w/w (bp)	Δ vs pre-war (bp)	BBG ticker
10Y breakeven inflation	2.271	+7.5	+0.7	+1.4 (from 2.257%) — back ABOVE the pre-war anchor after three closes below	USGGBE10 Index
5Y5Y forward inflation	2.331	+6.8	+13.2	+18.9 (from 2.14%) — 2.3311%, a war high, 3.11 bp THROUGH the 2.30% trigger ; second reading above 2.30% on record	USGG5Y5Y Index
SOFR (lagged, 27 Jul)	3.64	—	—	series lags; unchanged through the FOMC hold	SOFRRATE Index

Cross-asset stress and political-transmission gauges — Bloomberg

Gauge	Latest	As of	Δ vs pre-war	Interpretation
DXY	100.87	30 Jul intraday	+3.26 (from 97.61)	DOWN 0.51 on the day, and down on a night when strikes on Iran resumed. No haven bid at all — consistent with the long end and breakevens: this is an inflation-credibility repricing, not a flight to quality.
MOVE	76.09	28 Jul close (29–30 Jul blank)	+2.71 (from 73.38)	Data gap: no post-FOMC reading. With the 30Y up 10.9 bp and 2s10s 9 bp steeper, rates vol has almost certainly risen; the 75 downgrade leg is treated as unresolved, not cleared.
VIX	18.21	28 Jul close (29–30 Jul blank)	−1.65 (from 19.86)	Same gap. Equities fell into the 29 Jul close (Dow −1.4%, S&P −0.5%), so this is stale on the low side.
AAA gasoline	\$4.75 /gal	27 Jul print (28–30 Jul pending)	+\$1.23 (from \$3.52, +34.9%)	Political-stress score reference — a third consecutive session with no print. AAA's own published regular-grade series is the cross-read and it turned: \$4.099 on 28 Jul, \$4.091 on 29 Jul, the first decline in weeks. The pump run looks stalled at the trigger, not through it.
DOE gasoline	\$4.096 /gal	27 Jul weekly print	+\$1.16 (from ~\$2.94, +39.4%)	Corroboration only. +9.5¢ on the week; EIA has refineries at 97.2% of capacity and crude stocks 7% below the five-year average, so there is no domestic slack to absorb another crude leg higher.

US retail gasoline — the two tracked series, 2026 year-to-date



AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump, daily) is the political-stress score reference (pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest confirmed print \$4.75 on 27 Jul — flat, and now three sessions without a print); USFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot, weekly) is the complementary gauge (pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest \$4.096 on 27 Jul, +9.5¢ on the week). The dotted line is the \$4.75 political→5 threshold: the scored series has been sitting exactly on it since 24 Jul without going through it. AAA's published regular-grade average eased 0.8¢ between 28 and 29 Jul, the first decline of the run, which argues the stall is real rather than a reporting artifact.

Strait operational state

Indicator	Current reading	Source
Strait closed · day ~152	Closed since 28 Feb; naval blockade plus escort operation unchanged. 28 Jul: 24 AIS-tracked transits (16 in / 8 out) plus 9 dark inbound and 6 dark outbound crossings via EO/SAR, nearly all through the northern corridor; 371 vessels at anchor; 81 AIS-dark tankers in 24 hours; last PortWatch daily count 10 transits (23 Jul) against ~88/day normal, about 11% of pre-crisis throughput; ~70% of observed tanker transits run AIS-off. War-risk premium ~8x pre-crisis, roughly \$2.5m per VLCC passage.	Windward / straits.live / IMF PortWatch / Lloyd's List
US STRIKES RESUMED — night of 29–30 Jul	The four-night pause (25–28 Jul), the longest of the war, is over. CENTCOM described the new strikes on Iranian territory as 'a powerful response to yesterday's attempted Iranian attacks on US forces based in the Middle East.' Trump beforehand: 'They're going to get a beating'; 'our turn.' Quiet-night count back to zero; targets, munitions and casualties not yet released. The proximate trigger: the IRGC Aerospace Force fired ballistic missiles at Muwaffaq Salti Air Base near Azraq, Jordan, and a CENTCOM facility (28 Jul 17:45 ET / early 29 Jul local) — Jordan reported five missiles intercepted and destroyed, no fatalities; CENTCOM confirmed no casualties or damage.	CENTCOM / Jordan News Agency / Bloomberg / CNBC / CBS News / AP-NPR / Al Jazeera

Indicator	Current reading	Source
Saudi Arabia enters combat — joint US–Saudi strikes in Iraq	US and Saudi aircraft struck 'multiple terrorist logistics and weapons sites across eastern Iraq' in response to 'over 30 IRGC-directed aerial drone attacks in the last 72 hours.' PMF reported at least 20 killed, 32 wounded. Riyadh's first offensive action of the war; these strikes hit Iraq, not Iran, so they were not themselves the campaign resumption.	CENTCOM 28 Jul / CBS News / AP-NPR / Gulf News
Mediation COLLAPSED — Iran rejects the Omani plan, 29 Jul	Deputy FM Kazem Gharibabadi rejected Oman's 50-50 joint-management proposal on state television: 'If the route we have proposed is not accepted, no other formula will be accepted. The strait will remain closed, and we are prepared for a restart of war.' Iran also disavowed the internationally established Traffic Separation Scheme and demands the inbound lane entirely under its own control, reportedly at ~\$1m per ship against Malacca's ~\$70m a year in voluntary contributions. Oman is weighing a three-route alternative. No US response to the rejection itself could be found. The 28 Jul Khatam al-Anbiya bar on vessels accepting frozen-asset compensation remains in force, and the IRGC Navy said on 29 Jul it 'targeted and stopped' three unnamed oil tankers (Tier 3, unconfirmed).	Reuters / WSJ / Al Jazeera / Middle East Eye / Tasnim (Tier 3)
Red Sea / Saudi front — active again; a new Mediterranean front	Houthi spokesman Saree claimed a ballistic-missile hit on the Saudi-flagged tanker NCC GHAZAL on 28 Jul; UKMTO confirmed an explosion, crew safe. Further Houthi attacks on Saudi oil facilities and Bab al-Mandeb shipping on 29 Jul; Bab al-Mandeb ran 19 in / 18 out on 28 Jul, down 22% since the 20 Jul blockade declaration, tanker transits down 39%. Jizan refinery (400k b/d) still shut since 25 Jul; Yanbu loadings ~3.09 mb/d against ~5.16 before 19 Jul; satellite imagery suggested possible damage at Abqaiq on 27–28 Jul (unverified). Separately, drones struck two gas carriers at Egypt's Mediterranean port of Damietta on 29 Jul — Gaslog Salem and Energos Winter (US-owned and operated) — fires on both, no casualties, attribution unconfirmed. First strike of the war on that end of the LNG chain.	Al Jazeera / UKMTO / Windward / Maritime Executive / Reuters-Ambrey / Tech Times

2 · US economic shock — analysis with bond yields

The US economic shock holds at 25/30 for a twelfth session while the ground under it moved more than on any day since the crisis-band crossing on 9 Jul. On the event side everything got worse: the strike pause ended, Iran fired at a US base in Jordan, Saudi Arabia joined offensive operations, CENTCOM went back into Iranian territory, and Tehran killed the only mediation framework on the table while saying it is 'prepared for a restart of war.' None of that can move the score, because maritime and escalation have been at 5/5 since 10 and 9 Jul. Readers should take the flat number as evidence that the scale has run out of room on the geopolitical side, not as evidence of stability. The four market channels are where the information is, and this morning they all point the same way for the first time in a fortnight. The FOMC held at 3.50–3.75% against three dissents for a hike, and the long end responded by repricing inflation risk rather than growth risk: the 30Y through 5.20% for the first time on record, 2s10s 9 bp steeper, the 10Y breakeven back above its pre-war anchor, 5Y5Y at a war high through its own trigger, and the dollar lower on a night of renewed strikes. Yesterday's likeliest next move was a Treasury downgrade; today the two live candidates are both upgrades, and both are one confirmed close away.

2.1 · Bond-yield transmission

30 Jul yields are intraday; the 29 Jul row in the extract is a stale snapshot, so the last confirmed close is 28 Jul and all trigger tests below run off it. No channel moved; score held at 25.

(i) US inflation impulse — held at 4, but the trigger is through on the print. 5Y5Y forward inflation prints 2.3311% this morning: a war high, 3.11 bp above the 2.30% upgrade line, and only the second reading above 2.30% in the whole series after 2.3007% on 7 May. It is up 6.84 bp on the day and 13.16 bp on the week from 2.1995% on 23 Jul. The corroboration turned with it: the 10Y breakeven rose 7.52 bp to 2.2708%, back above its 2.2569% pre-war anchor after three consecutive closes below, so the two measures are no longer telling different stories. The mechanism is legible — a hold against three hike dissents, delivered by a Chair who has removed forward guidance and whose message is rhetorical rather than operational ('There is only a target, and it is 2 percent'; 'where necessary and appropriate, we will not hesitate to act'), against a statement that itself concedes inflation is above target 'due in part to the situation in the Middle East causing energy prices to rise.' The market read that as tolerance and demanded compensation. The discipline is unchanged and it is the whole reason the score is still 25: this is one intraday print, and the channel needs one confirmed close above 2.30% to start the clock and a second consecutive close to fire. On 14 Jul the monitor held this same channel at 3 on a 2.2061% close with a 0.6 bp margin and was vindicated; the same rule now costs a point in the other direction, which is the price of not whipsawing. If it confirms, the channel goes to 5/5 and the score to 26. The downgrade (sustained at or below the 2.142% anchor, now 18.91 bp away) is not in play.

(ii) Treasury — held at 5; the downgrade that was one session away on Tuesday is now gone. The 30Y prints 5.2060%, up 10.91 bp, which widens its cushion above the 5.00% downgrade leg from 8.86 bp on the 28 Jul close to 20.60 bp — a full reversal of three consecutive sessions of approach. The MOVE leg cannot be tested at all: the series has not printed since 28 Jul (76.09), so there is no post-FOMC reading, and with the 30Y up 10.9 bp and the curve 9 bp steeper the honest treatment is that rates vol is unresolved rather than 1.09 pts from release. Both legs must clear simultaneously and sustain; neither is close now. The more important point is the character of the move. This is a bear steepener with breakevens up and the dollar down — 2Y lower 2.5 bp, 30Y higher 10.9 bp, 2s10s +8.97 bp to +40.67 bp, the largest one-day steepening of the war and a 16.4 bp retracement from the 24 Jun low of +24.25 bp. Long-duration risk premium is being rebuilt at the same time as the front end prices less near-term tightening, which is the signature of a market pricing inflation persistence rather than Fed resolve. September hike odds have moved to roughly 56% from 32–38% before the meeting. A Treasury upgrade is not available (the channel is already maxed), so this repricing shows up in the score only through Stage-4 Threshold B and through the inflation channel — which is precisely where it has gone.

(iii) Oil — held at 2; the news is far worse and the price is only \$2.68 better. Brent prints \$87.72 intraday, a second consecutive gain, with active COA at \$89.96 against Tuesday's \$84.09 close. But the close-basis gap to the \$95 trigger is still \$12.92 measured from the last confirmed close, and \$7.28 from this morning's print. That is the striking thing about this edition: the pause broke, Saudi Arabia entered the war, mediation collapsed and Iran threatened a restart, and crude added under \$3. The physical picture argues for more — Jizan's 400k b/d refinery shut since 25 Jul, Yanbu loadings at ~3.09 mb/d against ~5.16 before 19 Jul, possible Abqaiq damage on 27–28 Jul, roughly 1.5 mb/d of CPC Black Sea exports still at risk, a US crude draw of 7.2 mb to 404.5 mb and refineries at 97.2% of capacity. Against it sit OPEC+ (a fifth consecutive monthly increase of 188k b/d for August, a further ~188k b/d expected at the 2 Aug meeting before a pause after September) and the IEA's remaining stock capacity (290 mb released since 11 March, over 1 bn bbl left). The two-close rule kept this channel at 2 through the \$95 approach on 23 Jul and through the \$12.18 unwind that followed; it stays at 2 now. The downgrade to 1 needs a mediated pause AND a close at or below \$72.48 — and with Oman's framework rejected, the mediated-pause condition has moved from plausible to remote, which effectively takes the downgrade off the table even though the price leg is only \$9.60 away.

(iv) Political — held at 4; the pump series has stalled exactly on its line and the cross-read says it is real. AUTMUSAG has not printed since 27 Jul (\$4.75), a third consecutive blank session, and per the discipline established after the JGLA episode a missing print is flagged, never carried. The useful new information is external: AAA's own published regular-grade national average went \$4.099 on 28 Jul to \$4.091 on 29 Jul, the first decline of the run. So the nine-session climb that ended flat exactly at \$4.75 on 24–27 Jul looks like a genuine stall rather than a reporting artifact, and the channel is more likely to be held at 4 by the pump than taken to 5 by it. The DOE weekly cuts the other way (+9.5¢ to \$4.096 for the week of 27 Jul), and with refineries maxed at 97.2%, gasoline stocks ~6% below the five-year average and the SPR down to ~311 mb from 415 mb in late March, a sustained crude leg higher would pass through quickly. No federal intervention — SPR release, export limit, waiver or gouging action — is confirmable in the 28–30 Jul window.

2.2 · What would push the shock to Stage 4

Stage 4 is a credit/auction event. Threshold B, disarmed on both legs yesterday, satisfies both legs on this morning's print for the first time in the war — on an intraday basis only.

Threshold A · 13 May 30Y auction, cleared 5.050%. Historical benchmark. The 9 Jul re-opening cleared 5.06% with a 0.3 bp stop-through. The 30Y now prints 5.2060%, 15.6 bp above the May stop and the widest margin since that auction. There is no coupon supply until the August refunding cycle, which means the next real test of long-end demand arrives with a curve that has just repriced 11 bp in a session.

Threshold B · 30Y above 5.20% with 10Y above 4.65% — BOTH LEGS ARMED, intraday. The 30Y prints 5.2060%, 0.60 bp through its leg and the first reading above 5.20% in the series; the 10Y prints 4.6794%, 2.94 bp through its own leg, undoing the reset that two consecutive sub-4.65% closes had produced on 28–29 Jul. This is the first time in the war both legs have been satisfied simultaneously. It is not a Stage-4 event: the threshold is evaluated on confirmed closes and then on persistence, and one Singapore-morning print supplies

neither. What it does mean is that B has gone from disarmed to live inside twenty-four hours, and that the mechanism now arming it is domestic monetary credibility rather than a Hormuz headline. A confirmed close on both legs tonight is the single most consequential thing that could happen to this monitor this week.

Threshold C · MOVE above 130. Cannot be evaluated. The series has not printed since 76.09 on 28 Jul, so there is no post-FOMC reading; the last observation is stale on the low side and is treated as a data gap rather than as reassurance. C was far off on Tuesday and is very probably still far off, but a 10.9 bp long-end move with a 9 bp steepening will not have left rates vol where it was.

2.3 · Cross-asset

The cross-asset signature changed shape. For most of July the tape traded Hormuz headlines: crude, European gas and Asia LNG moved together, the dollar was inert and rates followed risk. This morning the driver is the Fed. Crude and TTF are up (Brent +\$2.68, TTF +€1.53, back within €2.95 of the 24 Jul record) on the strike resumption and the collapse of the Omani framework, but the scale of those gains is modest against the scale of the news. The rates complex, by contrast, moved hard and in the specific pattern that says inflation rather than fear: 30Y +10.9 bp, 2s10s +9.0 bp, 10Y breakeven +7.5 bp back through its pre-war anchor, 5Y5Y +6.8 bp to a war high, 2Y -2.5 bp, and DXY -0.51 to 100.87 on a night when the United States resumed bombing Iran. A weaker dollar and steeper curve into renewed war is not a haven bid; it is the market charging a higher premium to hold long-dated US nominal risk. Two gaps qualify the read: MOVE and VIX have no post-FOMC print, so the volatility leg of the story is unmeasured, and equities fell into the 29 Jul close (Dow -1.4%, S&P 500 -0.5%, Nasdaq -0.5%) which the stale VIX does not reflect. Henry Hub remains 10.9% BELOW pre-war — the Hormuz/LNG-routing signature intact, this is still not a global-energy shock — while the Damietta strike on two gas carriers, one US-owned, extends the LNG-chain risk to the Mediterranean for the first time.

3 · Shock score

Total: 25/30 — CRISIS band. Band thresholds: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · 22–30 crisis.

Channel	Score	Rationale	Triggers
Maritime denial	5/5	Held at 5 (max). Strait closed to commercial traffic, day ~152; 28 Jul saw 24 AIS-tracked transits plus 15 dark crossings against ~88/day normal, roughly 11% of pre-crisis throughput; ~70% of tanker transits run AIS-off; 371 vessels at anchor; ~80 Iranian mines still in place with third-party clearance refused. Iran rejected the only reopening framework on the table and said the strait 'will remain closed'; IRGC stopped three more tankers.	↑ at max. ↓ verified reopening (escorted convoys) with traffic above 25% of normal for 10 sessions → to 3–4.
Oil price shock	2/5	Held at 2. Last confirmed close \$82.08 (28 Jul), \$12.92 below the \$95 trigger; intraday \$87.72 (+\$2.68), \$7.28 below it, active COA \$89.96. Crude added under \$3 on a day that brought a strike resumption, Saudi entry into combat and the collapse of mediation — the supply-side crosscurrents (OPEC+ increases, over 1 bn bbl of IEA stock capacity) are doing real work against the physical damage.	↑ Brent above \$95 sustained → to 3. ↓ mediated pause + close at/below the \$72.48 anchor → to 1 (the pause condition is now remote after Iran's rejection).
US inflation impulse	4/5	Held at 4 — but the trigger is THROUGH on this morning's print. 5Y5Y 2.3311%, a war high, 3.11 bp above the 2.30% line, +6.8 bp d/d and +13.2 bp w/w; only the second reading above 2.30% on record. 10Y breakeven +7.5 bp to 2.2708%, back above its pre-war anchor after three closes below. Needs one confirmed close to start the clock and a second to fire — the two-close rule is the only thing holding this at 4.	↑ 5Y5Y sustained above 2.30% → to 5. ↓ 5Y5Y sustained at/below the 2.142% pre-war anchor → to 3.
Treasury stress	5/5	Held at 5 (max) — and the downgrade that was one session away on Tuesday has gone. The 30Y prints 5.2060%, widening its cushion above the 5.00% leg from 8.86 bp to 20.60 bp; MOVE has not printed since 28 Jul so its 75 leg is unresolved, not cleared. A bear steepener with breakevens up and the dollar down is the FOMC hold being marked as inflation tolerance.	↑ at max. ↓ 30Y close under 5.00% with MOVE under 75 sustained → to 4.
Political stress	4/5	Held at 4. AUTMUSAG has not printed since \$4.75 on 27 Jul — a third blank session, flagged and not carried. The external cross-read points to a stall rather than a break: AAA's published regular-grade average eased from \$4.099 (28 Jul) to \$4.091 (29 Jul), the first decline of the run. DOE weekly \$4.096 (+9.5¢) cuts the other way, and with refineries at 97.2% and the SPR at ~311 mb there is no slack if crude runs.	↑ gasoline above \$4.75 sustained → to 5. ↓ toward the \$3.52 pre-war level → to 3.
Escalation risk	5/5	Held at 5 (max) on a day that would otherwise have forced an upgrade. The pause is over: an IRGC missile salvo at a US base in Jordan (intercepted), joint US–Saudi strikes on Iran-backed militias in Iraq with at least 20 killed, CENTCOM back over Iranian territory on the night of 29–30 Jul, Iran's rejection of the Omani plan and its statement that it is 'prepared for a restart of war,' plus a first strike on gas carriers at Damietta. The channel cannot register any of it.	↑ at max. ↓ mediated stand-down + talks resume → to 4–3.
TOTAL	25/30	CRISIS band — a twelfth session at 25, and the clearest scale-cap edition of the war. Every geopolitical input deteriorated and the score could not move, because both event channels have been maxed since 9–10 Jul. Meanwhile two market lines that were disarmed yesterday are armed today on intraday prints: US-inflation is 3.11 bp through its trigger and Stage-4 Threshold B satisfies both legs for the first time in the war. The two-close rule, not the situation, is what is holding 25.	

4 · What's changed since the last edition (29 Jul → 30 Jul AM)

Score holds at 25/30 for a twelfth session. No channel moved. But the strike pause ended, mediation collapsed, the FOMC held against three hike dissents, and two market lines armed intraday. Source: Bloomberg unless stated.

The strike pause is over, and the coalition widened. After four quiet nights (25–28 Jul), the longest of the war, CENTCOM resumed strikes on Iranian territory on the night of 29–30 Jul, 'a powerful response to yesterday's attempted Iranian attacks on US forces based in the Middle East.' The trigger was an intercepted IRGC ballistic-missile salvo at Muwaffaq Salti Air Base in Jordan and a CENTCOM facility; the first answer was joint US–Saudi strikes on Iran-backed militias across eastern Iraq (at least 20 killed), Riyadh's first offensive combat action of the war. Quiet-night count back to zero. Source: CENTCOM / Jordan News Agency / Bloomberg / CNBC / CBS News / AP-NPR / Gulf News.

Iran rejected Oman's Hormuz framework outright. Deputy FM Kazem Gharibabadi, on state television on 29 Jul: 'If the route we have proposed is not accepted, no other formula will be accepted. The strait will remain closed, and we are prepared for a restart of war.' Iran disavowed the internationally established Traffic Separation Scheme, demanded the entire inbound lane under its own control, and reportedly sought ~\$1m per ship. Oman is weighing a three-route alternative. No US response to the rejection itself could be found. Source: Reuters / WSJ / Al Jazeera / Middle East Eye.

The FOMC held at 3.50–3.75% on a 9–3 vote, with three dissents for a hike. Hammack, Kashkari and Logan all voted for 25 bp. The statement said activity is 'expanding at a solid pace despite elevated uncertainty that owes, in part, to the conflict in the Middle East' and that inflation remains above target 'due in part to the situation in the Middle East causing energy prices to rise.' Chair Warsh, who has removed forward guidance: 'There is only a target, and it is 2 percent'; 'where necessary and appropriate, we will not hesitate to act.' September hike odds moved to roughly 56% from 32–38%. Source: Federal Reserve press conference transcript / Fox Business / Kiplinger / CNN.

The 30Y printed above 5.20% for the first time on record, arming Stage-4 Threshold B on both legs. The 30Y is 5.2060% intraday (+10.91 bp), 0.60 bp through its Stage-4 leg; the 10Y is 4.6794% (+6.50 bp), 2.94 bp through its own, undoing the reset produced by two sub-4.65% closes. 2s10s steepened 8.97 bp to +40.67 bp, the largest one-day steepening of the war. Intraday only — B needs confirmed closes. The same move killed the Treasury downgrade: the 30Y's cushion above its 5.00% leg widened from 8.86 bp on Tuesday's close to 20.60 bp, and MOVE has not printed since 28 Jul (76.09), so its 75 leg is unresolved rather than near release. Source: Bloomberg.

5Y5Y forward inflation broke 2.30% to a war high. 2.3311% (+6.84 bp d/d, +13.16 bp w/w from 2.1995% on 23 Jul), 3.11 bp through the US-inflation upgrade trigger and only the second reading above 2.30% on record after 7 May. The 10Y breakeven rose 7.52 bp to 2.2708%, back above its pre-war anchor after three closes below. One confirmed close starts the clock; a second takes the channel to 5 and the score to 26. Source: Bloomberg.

A new front: gas carriers hit at Damietta, Egypt. Drones struck the Gaslog Salem (Bermuda flag) and the Energos Winter (Marshall Islands, US-owned and operated) at Egypt's Mediterranean port of Damietta on 29 Jul; fires on both, no casualties, attribution unconfirmed. First strike of the war on the Mediterranean end of the LNG chain. Source: Maritime Executive / Reuters-Ambrey / UKMT0.

The extract's 29 Jul row never refreshed. Every 29 Jul field is identical to my 29 Jul AM snapshot to four decimal places and MOVE, VIX and SOFR are blank, so there is no 29 Jul close in the data and no reconciliation gap to report. Third-party reporting puts the true 29 Jul close at 2Y 4.33% and 10Y 4.647%, above the stale row. The last fully confirmed close is 28 Jul and every trigger test in this edition runs off it. Source: Bloomberg extract / Kiplinger.

5 · Scenario map · next 7 to 30 days

Scenario	P	Description	Market path
Return to full war	38%	Sharply higher and now the strongest reading of the war. The pause is over, CENTCOM is back over Iran, Saudi Arabia is flying offensive missions, Iran has said it is 'prepared for a restart of war,' and the mediation track that restrained all of this for five days no longer exists.	Brent \$105–140; MOVE above 90; oil to 3–4, political to 5, US-inflation to 5; score 28–30.
Deal collapse — talks stall on terms	24%	Raised again. Iran did not stall on Oman's plan, it rejected it and disavowed the Traffic Separation Scheme underlying any lane arrangement. Oman's three-route alternative keeps a thread alive, but the gap is now over sovereignty, not sequencing.	Brent \$92–108; oil to 3; 30Y sustained above 5.20% with the 10Y above 4.65%, i.e. Stage-4 B confirmed; score 26–27.
Contained but violent — blockaded stalemate	16%	Lower. This scenario required strikes to stay paused at low intensity; they have resumed, and Saudi entry raises the floor on intensity. It survives only if the resumption is a single retaliatory cycle rather than a new campaign.	Brent \$82–92; MOVE 72–82; risk premium \$10–20/bbl; score holds 24–25.
Regional relapse — Gulf energy infrastructure hit	14%	Slightly higher. The Red Sea front reactivated (NCC GHAZAL hit 28 Jul, further Saudi and Bab al-Mandeb attacks 29 Jul), Jizan is still shut, Abqaiq may have taken damage on 27–28 Jul, and Damietta shows reach onto the Mediterranean. A landed hit on the Saudi export corridor is the tail that reprices everything.	Brent \$150+; emergency policy response; HY spreads above 500 bp; score 29–30.
Mediated pause — the ceasefire sticks	8%	Collapsed from 23%. Twenty-four hours ago this was within a point of modal on four quiet nights and a tabled Omani framework. Iran rejected the framework, fired at a US base and drew a resumption; the pause it described no longer exists.	Brent \$74–85; MOVE under 72; Treasury→4, US-inflation→3, escalation→4; score falls toward 19–21.

Probability shifts from the 29 Jul edition: mediated pause –15 (23→8) — the single largest one-day move in this map since the war began, and it is a collapse, not a drift; full war +12 (26→38), the highest reading of the war, on the resumption plus Iran's own 'prepared for a restart of war'; deal collapse +4 (20→24) on an outright rejection rather than a stall; regional relapse +1 (13→14) on the reactivated Red Sea front and Damietta; contained-but-violent –2 (18→16) because its precondition, a holding pause, is gone. Driver: the de-escalation track that dominated the past week was dismantled in a single 24-hour cycle.

6 · Watchlist · next 24 to 72 hours

US-inflation →5 — the trigger is already through; it needs closes. 5Y5Y prints 2.3311%, 3.11 bp above the 2.30% line and a war high. One confirmed close above 2.30% starts the clock and a second consecutive close takes the channel to 5/5 and the score to 26. This is now the nearest score move and it is an upgrade. Watch whether the post-FOMC breakeven bid holds through a full US session.

Stage-4 Threshold B — both legs armed for the first time in the war. 30Y 5.2060% (0.60 bp through) and 10Y 4.6794% (2.94 bp through), on intraday prints. A confirmed close on both, then persistence, is the most consequential single development available this week. The August refunding cycle is the next coupon-supply test and it now meets a curve that has repriced 11 bp in a session.

MOVE — the missing number. No print since 76.09 on 28 Jul, so there is no post-FOMC rates-vol reading. It matters twice: it is the second leg of the Treasury downgrade test (moot for now) and it is Threshold C. Verify it fresh in the next extract rather than inferring it.

Whether the resumption is one cycle or a new campaign — and whether Oman's three-route alternative gets any Iranian engagement. Four quiet nights ended with a single retaliatory night. A second and third consecutive night of strikes on Iranian territory converts this from a retaliation cycle into a restarted campaign and would put full war well above 38%; a return to quiet inside 48 hours partially restores the contained-but-violent path. On the diplomatic leg, Gharibabadi's 'no other formula will be accepted' closes the door rhetorically, but Al Jazeera's sources reported some Iranian flexibility on routing before the rejection — any re-engagement is the only path back toward the mediated-pause branch, now at 8%.

Oil's failure to price the escalation. Brent added under \$3 on a day that produced a strike resumption, Saudi combat entry and the collapse of mediation. Either the market is discounting the resumption as a one-off, or OPEC+ supply and IEA stocks are absorbing more risk premium than assumed. The 2 Aug OPEC+ meeting (a further ~188k b/d expected, then a pause after September) is the test.

Political →5 — stalled at the line, and the cross-read now argues against it. AUTMUSAG has been blank for three sessions at \$4.75; AAA's published regular-grade average eased 0.8¢ between 28 and 29 Jul. Watch the backfill: a print below \$4.75 would take the political channel off its trigger for the first time since 24 Jul.

Gas complex — verify the next JGLA print fresh, and watch the Mediterranean. Asia LNG has had no print for two sessions (last ¥3,418 on 28 Jul) and is never carried forward. TTF is back within €2.95 of its war record. The Damietta strike on two gas carriers, one US-owned, is the first hit on the Mediterranean end of the LNG chain and a new risk vector for both series.

7 · Source log · this edition

Tier 1 — primary market data. Bloomberg Terminal extract (US Iran BBG Data.xlsx, restated front-month continuation series). Tickers: CO2/CL2 Comdty (front-month; the CL2 artifact persists — CL2 prints \$81.67 against active CLA \$84.10); COA/CLA Comdty (active, unscored — COA prints \$89.96 against Tuesday's \$84.09 close); NGA/TZTA/JGLA (JGLA last printed 28 Jul at ¥3,418; no 29 or 30 Jul print, flagged not carried); USGG2YR/5YR/10YR/20YR/30YR (30Y 5.2060% — first print above 5.20% in the series); USYC2Y10 (+40.672, +8.97 bp, largest one-day steepening of the war); USGGBE10 (2.2708 — back above the pre-war anchor); USGG5Y5Y (2.3311 — war high, 3.11 bp through the →5 trigger); SOFRRATE (lagged, 27 Jul, 3.64%); MOVE and VIX (no print since the 28 Jul closes 76.09 / 18.21 — treated as a data gap, carried and labelled); DXY (100.869, -0.51); AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades pump — score reference; last print \$4.75 on 27 Jul, 28–30 Jul pending) and USRFRUSA (DOE regular spot, weekly — corroboration; \$4.096 for the week of 27 Jul). **Data-integrity note:** the extract's 29 Jul row did not refresh — identical to my 29 Jul AM snapshot to four decimal places with MOVE/VIX/SOFR blank — so it is treated as a stale snapshot and the last confirmed close is 28 Jul.

Tier 1 — news and institutional. US CENTCOM (strike resumption on the night of 29–30 Jul, 'a powerful response to yesterday's attempted Iranian attacks on US forces based in the Middle East'; the 28 Jul joint US–Saudi release on eastern Iraq, 'over 30 IRGC-directed aerial drone attacks in the last 72 hours') via Bloomberg, CNBC, CNN, NBC News, Times of Israel and Al Jazeera; Jordan News Agency and Jordan's military (five ballistic missiles intercepted over Jordan, no fatalities) via AP-NPR, CBS News and Gulf News; Reuters, the Wall Street Journal, Al Jazeera and Middle East Eye (Gharibabadi's 29 Jul rejection of Oman's 50-50 plan, the disavowal of the Traffic Separation Scheme, the ~\$1m-per-ship demand and Oman's three-route alternative); Popular Mobilisation Forces casualty reports via CBS News and AP-NPR; Axios, UPI, Jerusalem Post and Times of Israel (the 28 Jul Netanyahu–Trump meeting and its 29–30 Jul readouts — no Israeli action against Iran in the window); Federal Reserve (FOMC statement and Chair Warsh's 29 Jul press-conference transcript) with CME FedWatch via Fox Business, Kiplinger, CNN and CBS News (9–3 hold at 3.50–3.75%, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissenting for 25 bp, September odds ~56%); Windward, straits.live, IMF PortWatch and Lloyd's List Intelligence (Hormuz transit and AIS-gap counts, 371 vessels at anchor, ~70% AIS-off tanker transits, Bab al-Mandeb 19 in / 18 out on 28 Jul, Yanbu loadings 5.16 → 3.09 mb/d); Maritime Executive, Reuters-Ambrey and UKMTO (the 29 Jul Damietta drone strike on Gaslog Salem and Energos Winter; the 28 Jul NCC GHAZAL explosion); EIA Weekly Petroleum Status Report of 29 Jul (crude -7.2 mb to 404.5 mb, refinery utilisation 97.2%, gasoline stocks ~6% below the five-year average) and the EIA Gasoline and Diesel Fuel Update; AAA published pump averages for 28–29 Jul; Bloomberg via OilPrice and Energy Connects (OPEC+ +188k b/d for August, a further ~188k b/d expected at the 2 Aug meeting then a pause after September); IEA via PGJ and Business Recorder (290 mb released since 11 March, over 1 bn bbl of emergency stocks remaining); S&P Global Commodity Insights (CPC Black Sea disruption, ~1.5 mb/d at risk); Tech Times citing NASA FIRMS (the 25 Jul Jizan refinery strike and Yanbu intercepts; unverified reports of Abqaiq damage on 27–28 Jul).

Tier 3 — state media and combatant claims (labelled). The IRGC Navy claim on 29 Jul to have 'targeted and stopped' three oil tankers for ignoring warnings is reported by Tasnim and Anadolu with no vessel names and is not independently confirmed; it is treated as a stated enforcement claim, not a verified change in transit access, and moves nothing. The IRGC's own account of the Jordan missile launch, relayed by IRNA with released footage, is corroborated as to the launch by CENTCOM and the Jordanian military, which also confirm the interceptions. The 28 Jul Khatam al-Anbiya Central Headquarters bar on vessels accepting frozen-asset compensation (Press TV, Xinhua) remains a declared policy position. The Houthis claim to the NCC GHAZAL strike is a combatant claim, corroborated by UKMTO as to the explosion; attribution of the Damietta strike is unconfirmed and is reported as such. Iranian media claims that four Iranians died in the Iraq strikes are unverified.

8 · On-demand update protocol

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh the Bloomberg extract	Parse the latest dated row (30 Jul) as intraday; re-map columns via the robust scan (front-month CO2/CL2). Integrity check caught a stale row: the 29 Jul line never refreshed — identical to the prior AM snapshot to four decimals, MOVE/VIX/SOFR blank — so 28 Jul remains the last confirmed close. JGLA checked fresh: last print 28 Jul ¥3,418, none since, flagged not carried. AUTMUSAG blank for a third session at \$4.75, flagged not carried. MOVE/VIX carried from the 28 Jul closes and labelled as a data gap. SOFR lagged, 27 Jul.
2	Recompute deltas	d/d vs the (unrefreshed) 29 Jul row, labelled indicative; w/w vs the close five trading sessions back (23 Jul this edition); vs-pre-war against the 27 Feb 2026 anchor, re-verified field by field and unchanged.
3	Re-evaluate the six channels	Market channels move on confirmed closes only — all four held. Oil 2 (last close \$82.08, \$12.92 below \$95). US-inflation 4 despite 5Y5Y printing 2.3311%, 3.11 bp THROUGH the 2.30% trigger, because no close confirms it. Treasury 5 (30Y 5.2060% intraday, cushion above the 5.00% leg widened to 20.60 bp; MOVE unresolved). Political 4 (AAA \$4.75 confirmed, three sessions stale). Maritime and escalation are event-based and both maxed, so the strike resumption, Saudi combat entry and Iran's rejection of the Omani plan register in the narrative but not the score.
4	Reconcile against the prior edition	Not possible this session: with no 29 Jul close in the extract there is no gap to measure. Recorded instead as a data-integrity exception, with third-party 29 Jul closes (2Y 4.33%, 10Y 4.647%) noted as evidence the stale row understates the true level. Re-verify the 29 and 30 Jul closes in the next extract before trusting any d/d series through this window.
5	Update scenarios and watchlist	Re-rank catalysts: US-inflation→5 (already through the trigger, needs closes) replaces Treasury→4 as the nearest score move; Stage-4 Threshold B armed on both legs for the first time in the war; MOVE is a missing number, not a benign one; whether the resumption runs to a second and third night. Mediated pause 23→8, full war 26→38, deal collapse 20→24, regional relapse 13→14, contained-but-violent 18→16.

9 · Methodology

Shock-score scale. Six transmission channels (maritime denial, oil, US inflation impulse, Treasury stress, political stress, escalation risk), each 0–5, summed to 0–30. Bands: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · 22–30 crisis. Market channels move only on a confirmed close through a trigger; escalation-risk and maritime denial are event-based. **Hysteresis note:** upgrades fire on a sustained break, downgrades only on a sustained reversal past a wider threshold, deliberately, to avoid whipsawing. This edition is the most expensive test of the confirmed-close rule on the upside so far: 5Y5Y is 3.11 bp THROUGH its upgrade trigger on an intraday print and the channel still holds at 4, exactly as it held at 3 on 14 Jul against a 2.2061% close with a 0.6 bp margin before firing on the second consecutive close on 15 Jul. The same rule spared the oil channel a whipsaw through both the \$95 approach of 23 Jul and the \$12.18 unwind that followed. Stage-4 Threshold B is evaluated the same way, which is why both legs being satisfied this morning arms it rather than triggers it.

Scale cap — the governing feature of this edition. Maritime and escalation have been pinned at 5/5 since 10 and 9 Jul. On 30 Jul the strike pause ended, Iran fired ballistic missiles at a US base in Jordan, Saudi Arabia flew its first offensive missions of the war, CENTCOM returned to Iranian territory, Iran rejected the only reopening framework on the table and declared itself ready for a restart of war, and gas carriers were hit at Damietta. Not one of those inputs can raise the score, because the two channels that would register them are already at maximum. The flat 25 must be read as the scale exhausting its geopolitical range, not as a judgment that conditions are stable. Only the four market channels can move the number now, in either direction.

Data integrity this edition. The extract's 29 Jul row did not refresh: every field matches my 29 Jul AM snapshot to four decimal places and MOVE, VIX and SOFR are blank. It is therefore treated as a stale snapshot rather than a close, the last confirmed close is 28 Jul, and all trigger tests run off it; d/d deltas are labelled indicative. MOVE and VIX have no post-FOMC print at all, so the Treasury channel's volatility leg and Stage-4 Threshold C are recorded as unresolved rather than as reassuring. Per the discipline established after the JGLA stale-carry episode, a missing print is flagged and never carried forward as if fresh: JGLA (last 28 Jul) and AUTMUSAG (last 27 Jul) are flagged accordingly.

Gasoline series. Political stress is scored on AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump; pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest confirmed print \$4.75 on 27 Jul — flat, sitting exactly on the \$4.75 threshold since 24 Jul without going through it); the 28–30 Jul prints are pending and the channel holds until confirmed. USFRUSA (DOE regular spot; pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest \$4.096 for the week of 27 Jul, +9.5¢) is tracked alongside as corroboration only. Neither series is re-based. AAA's separately published regular-grade national average (\$4.099 on 28 Jul, \$4.091 on 29 Jul) is used in this edition only as an external cross-read on whether the stall in the scored series is real; it is not substituted for it.

Pre-war anchor (27 Feb 2026 close). Brent \$72.48; WTI \$67.02; 2Y 3.375%; 5Y 3.502%; 10Y 3.938%; 30Y 4.611%; 2s10s +55.64 bp; 5Y5Y 2.142%; 10Y BE 2.257%; MOVE 73.38; VIX 19.86; DXY 97.608; gasoline (AAA) \$3.52; Henry Hub \$3.06; TTF €31.23; Asia LNG ¥1,669. (Re-verified field by field — unchanged.) Brent +21.0%, WTI +21.9%, TTF +94.2%, Asia LNG +104.8%; the 30Y (+59.5 bp), 10Y (+74.2 bp), 5Y5Y (+18.9 bp), 10Y breakeven (+1.4 bp, back above after three closes below), MOVE (+2.71, stale) and DXY (+3.26) sit above their anchors; VIX (stale) and Henry Hub remain below pre-war, Henry Hub at −10.9%.

Intraday caveat. The latest dated row is a Singapore-AM snapshot and US hours set the close. This edition's snapshot is unusual in one respect that works in its favour: the FOMC decision landed at 2pm ET on 29 Jul, which is 02:00 Singapore on 30 Jul, so the 30 Jul morning print is the first reading that contains the post-FOMC repricing. It is still an intraday print and is treated as one. Recent Brent gaps between my snapshot and the subsequent close: +\$1.91, +\$0.60, +\$3.10, −\$1.81, −\$2.01, −\$3.32, and none measurable for 29 Jul. CL2 remains an artifact against active CLA. Triggers are evaluated on confirmed closes; escalation-risk and maritime denial are event-based. Restated-series levels are not comparable with pre-restatement editions, though the directional analysis is continuous.